

As a developer it's important to make the decision about what platform you're targeting your game at. With cheaper handsets available, developing for mobile devices is one of the most common choices among indie developers in India. A game targeted at the Indian audience will be better off if made for Android devices rather than iOS devices, as more people own an Android device in the country. There's also a huge diversity of devices, counting Android version numbers, screen sizes, resolutions and aspect ratios. You can choose iOS as a platform, over Android if you find this cumbersome. When you're developing a game for a platform, it should run on all devices supported by that platform. A game made for iOS should run on the iPhone 3G, 4G and iPhone 4S. You need all these devices to be able to testing the game before you release it.

A game designed with touch controls may need a redesign of controls when ported to a non-touch device. A game ported from PC to iPhone may need a lot of graphic and texture optimisation due to lesser available memory.

There's an industry standard for mobile computer graphics, called OpenGL ES (OpenGL for Embedded Systems), which is not supported by Windows Phone, as it uses Microsoft's own XNA for these purposes. So if you're learning Microsoft XNA, you can build for both Windows Phone and Xbox 360. However, some of you may choose to learn OpenGL ES instead, and focus your attention on the larger market share.

Know your audience

Game genre plays an important role in defining your target audience to an extent. Action game lovers will automatically become your target audience if your game falls in the Action genre. Casual games are made to be played by casual gamers, and are thus targeted at smart phones, tablets, etc. Hard-core gamers, on the other hand, love playing FPS or RPGs on their consoles and not *Angry Birds* or *Fruit Ninja*. If Facebook users are your audience, design your game using the network's viral features – your game will need to ensure that people can interact with friends within the game.

You can't make one game that the world will love as a whole, so don't try to achieve that. If you try and create a game that will capture both casual and hard-core gamers, you will probably make a game that neither group likes.

The next important decision variable is age. Decide whether your game is targeted at kids, teens or adults – this will influence factors such as colors, content, etc., of your game.